

Contents

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy	1
RWK-1. Purpose	1
RWK-2. Work-location designations	1
RWK-3. Eligibility	2
RWK-4. Approval and review	2
RWK-5. Approved work location	2
RWK-6. Schedule, availability, and time zones	3
RWK-7. Performance and conduct	3
RWK-8. Workspace, health, and safety	3
RWK-9. Information security and privacy	3
RWK-10. Equipment and expenses	3
RWK-11. Travel to an office or customer site	3
RWK-12. Business continuity	4
RWK-13. Responsibilities	4
RWK-14. Examples	4
Related policies and records	4

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Educational and synthetic policy corpus. Northstar Technologies Inc. is a fictional company created for an AI engineering project. All people, records, email addresses, examples, and operational data are synthetic. These documents are not legal advice and do not replace applicable law, benefit plan documents, signed employment agreements, or case-specific guidance from People Operations.

Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-RWK-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
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Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees with an Office-Based, Hybrid, or Remote work designation; contractors only when their agreement incorporates this policy
Classification	Internal

RWK-1. Purpose

This policy establishes work-location designations, eligibility, approval, schedule, performance, safety, security, equipment, and travel expectations for remote and hybrid work. It does not authorize work outside the employee's registered province, state, or country; those requests are governed by **POL-INT-001**.

RWK-2. Work-location designations

Every employee record must contain one of the following designations and a Registered Home Office.

Designation	Normal expectation
Office-Based	Works primarily from the assigned office. Occasional remote work of up to two days per calendar month may be approved by the manager.
Hybrid	Works from the assigned office at least two days per week or the greater team standard, and from the approved home workspace on other approved days.
Remote	Works primarily from the approved home workspace and attends planned onsite events or customer locations when required.

A manager may set common team anchor days. A designation is not an entitlement and does not prevent reasonable changes for business, performance, security, accommodation, or legal reasons.

RWK-3. Eligibility

A role is eligible only when its duties can be performed without material loss of customer service, collaboration, supervision, security, equipment access, or operational continuity. The manager and People Operations consider:

- role duties and need for physical presence;
- access to Confidential or Restricted data;
- performance, reliability, and ability to work independently;
- the proposed workspace, connectivity, and time-zone overlap;
- team coverage and customer commitments; and
- jurisdiction, payroll, tax, immigration, licensing, or client restrictions.

A recurring Hybrid or Remote arrangement normally begins after the first 60 calendar days of employment unless the employee was hired into that designation, an accommodation applies, or People Operations approves an earlier start.

RWK-4. Approval and review

A new or changed designation requires a documented request, manager recommendation, and People Operations approval. Information Security approval is also required when the role regularly handles Restricted data outside an office.

Approved arrangements are reviewed at least annually and when the employee changes role, manager, home address, jurisdiction, performance status, or client assignment. Silence or informal past practice is not approval.

RWK-5. Approved work location

Remote work may occur only at the approved home workspace or another location expressly approved for the relevant dates. The employee must keep the residential address and Registered Home Office current in the HR system.

Any work outside the registered province or state, including within the same country, must be assessed under **POL-INT-001** before travel. Working from another country while on personal vacation is still work and requires approval.

Public cafes, hotel lobbies, shared lounges, and transportation terminals are not approved locations for handling Confidential or Restricted information. A private coworking space may be approved when Security and the manager confirm appropriate controls.

RWK-6. Schedule, availability, and time zones

Employees must follow an approved schedule and comply with timekeeping requirements. Unless a team has a different documented schedule, employees must be available during core collaboration hours of 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in the employee's Registered Home Office time zone.

Remote work is not a substitute for dependent care during working hours. Brief, incidental interruptions are expected in normal life; recurring care needs require an approved schedule, PTO, or leave arrangement.

Employees must maintain calendar visibility, attend required meetings, respond within reasonable team norms, and notify the manager of outages or material schedule changes.

RWK-7. Performance and conduct

Performance, attendance, conduct, confidentiality, and customer-service standards are the same regardless of location. Managers should assess results and behavior rather than online presence alone. Surveillance tools may not be installed or used outside approved security and compliance processes.

A remote arrangement may be modified or ended when documented performance, collaboration, security, customer, or operational needs cannot be resolved. When practical, Northstar provides reasonable notice and an opportunity to discuss alternatives. Immediate changes may be required for a security, safety, legal, or client risk.

RWK-8. Workspace, health, and safety

The employee must maintain a reasonably safe, private, and functional workspace with adequate lighting, seating, electrical capacity, and internet access. Work-related injuries must be reported promptly to the manager and People Operations, even when they occur at home.

Northstar may request a self-assessment, photographs of company equipment placement, or a virtual ergonomic review. Northstar will not routinely inspect a residence without consent, but may require a different approved location when material risks cannot be addressed.

RWK-9. Information security and privacy

Employees must comply with **POL-SEC-001**, including company-managed device, multifactor authentication, VPN, screen privacy, storage, printing, and incident-reporting rules. Household members and visitors must not use company devices or view non-public company information.

Confidential conversations require a private setting and a headset when others may overhear. Paper containing Confidential or Restricted information should not be printed at home unless expressly approved and securely destroyed.

RWK-10. Equipment and expenses

Company equipment, home-office accessories, furniture reimbursement, internet stipends, repair, loss, and return are governed by **POL-EQP-001**. Reimbursements require compliance with **POL-EXP-001**. Employees should not purchase equipment with an expectation of reimbursement before receiving required approval.

RWK-11. Travel to an office or customer site

Normal travel between a Hybrid or Office-Based employee's residence and assigned office is commuting and is not reimbursable. Required travel by a Remote-designated employee to an office more than 50 kilometres or 30 miles from the approved home workspace is business travel when preapproved.

Remote employees may be required to attend up to four planned onsite events per calendar year with reasonable notice. Additional travel may be required by the role or employment agreement.

RWK-12. Business continuity

Employees should maintain a practical continuity plan for short internet or power outages. This may include a company-approved hotspot, alternate approved workspace, adjusted hours, PTO, or office attendance. Employees must not use an insecure location solely to remain online.

RWK-13. Responsibilities

- **Employee:** Maintain accurate location information, protect data, meet schedule and performance expectations, and report incidents.
- **Manager:** Assess role suitability consistently, define team norms, monitor outcomes, and escalate jurisdiction or security questions.
- **People Operations:** Approve designations, maintain records, coordinate accommodations, and interpret policy.
- **Information Security and IT:** Define technical controls, approve exceptions, and support secure equipment and access.

RWK-14. Examples

- A Hybrid employee may not independently work from another province for three weeks. The request must be reviewed under **POL-INT-001**.
- A Remote employee using a private home office may handle Confidential information on a company-managed device with required security controls.
- An Office-Based employee may request an occasional remote day, but repeated weekly remote work requires a designation review.
- A Remote employee required to attend a company summit in another city may claim preapproved business travel; a Hybrid employee's normal trip to the assigned office is commuting.

Related policies and records

- **POL-INT-001 - International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-EQP-001 - Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**